



Roamly

Explore, Contribute, Unlock

By An Nguyen

What is Roamly?

Simply put Roamly is a passive travel app that rewards you for sharing the routes you actually travel.

1. A passive travel app that logs the routes you actually travel.
2. Tap "Start Trip" and Roamly launches Google Maps for navigation while recording your path in the background.
3. Contributing your routes (at least one day of exploring) unlocks 1–2 real travel recommendations from other travelers.

Target Audience

- Frequent travelers, backpackers, and digital nomads who explore new places regularly.
- People who want authentic, traveler-discovered routes and spots — not commercial or sponsored listings.
- People that prefer passive application with simplistic UI navigation that builds results/progress over time.



Motivation

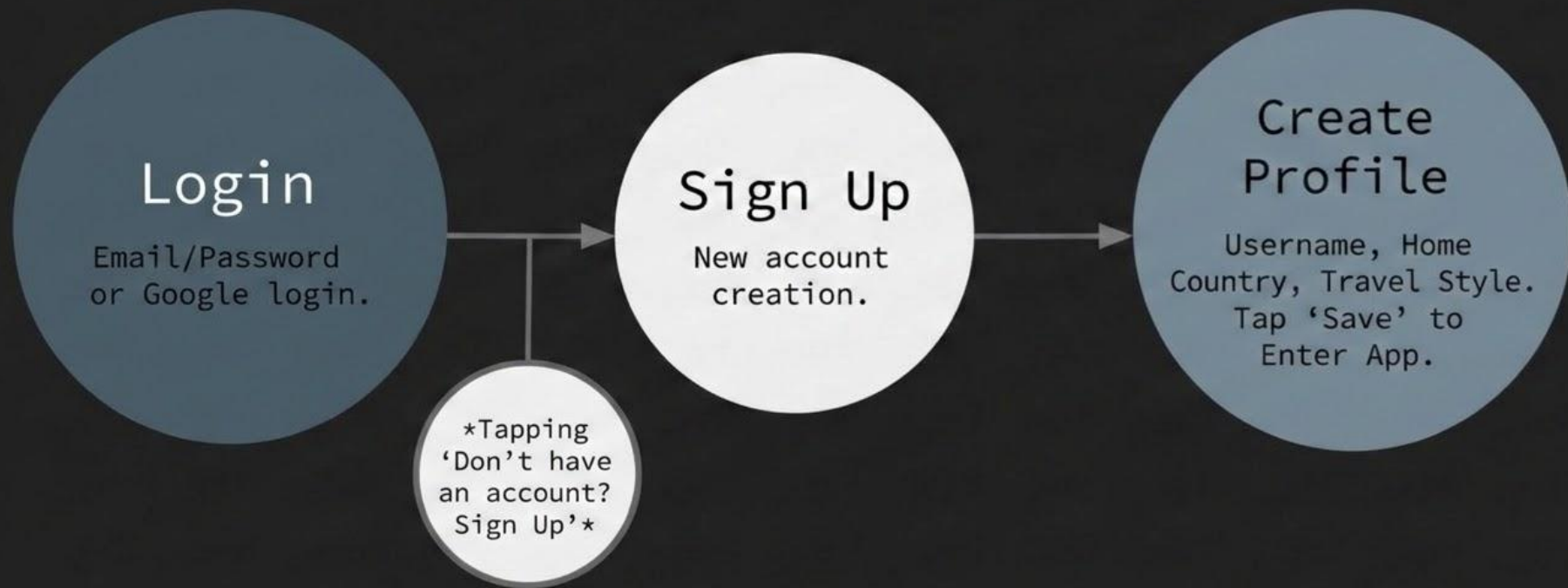
I got this idea because I thought there should be a passive travel recommendation/social app. Think of it like Strava, a fitness and social app, but for traveling.

- Travelers struggle to find genuine, non-commercial recommendations for where to go.
- Apps like Google Maps and TripAdvisor offer curated or sponsored listings, but few surface the organic paths real travelers actually take.

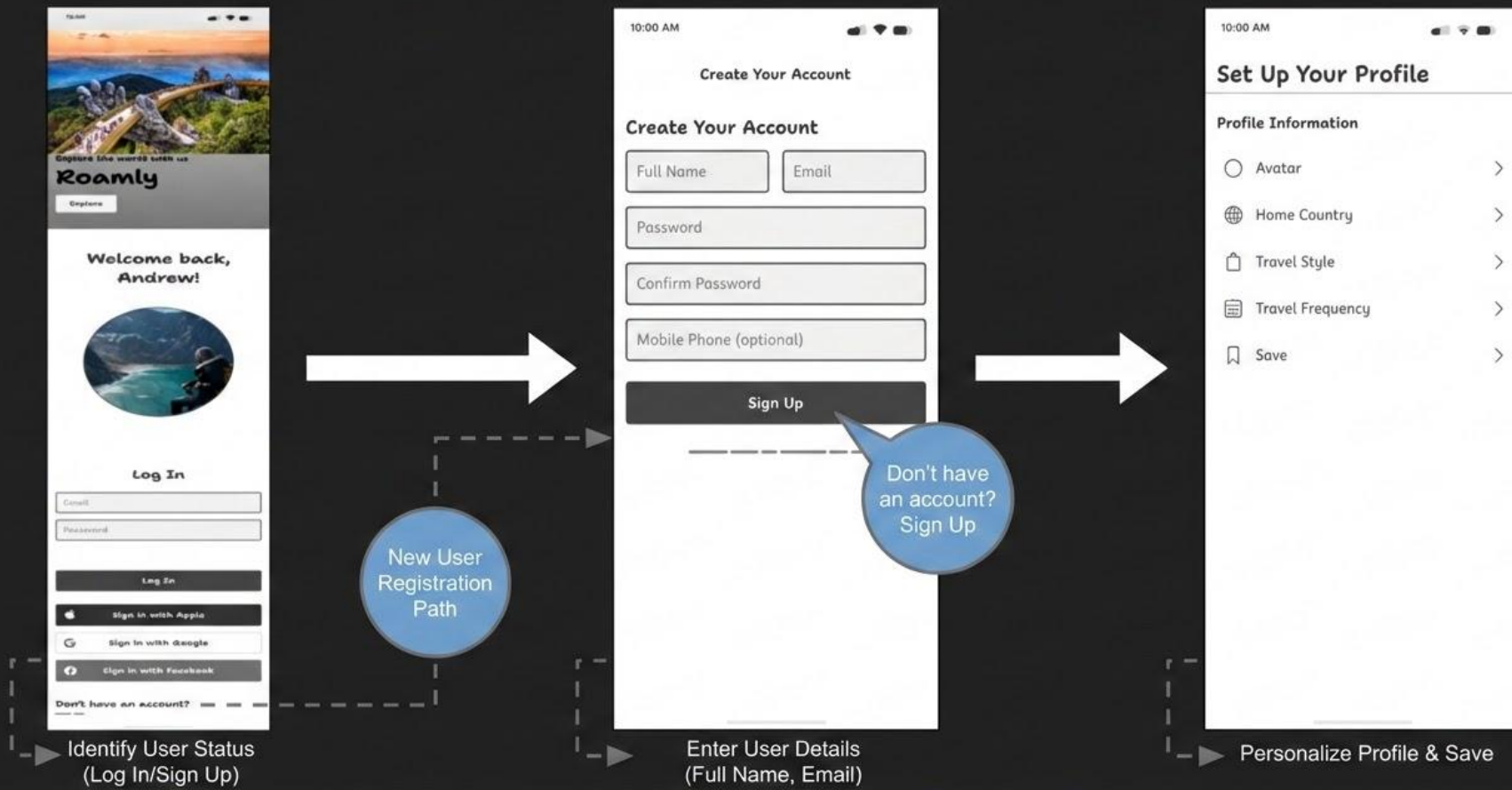
Roamly fills this gap with a give-to-get model: contribute your own routes to unlock others' similar to Strava's social layer applied to travel discovery. Additionally, you can pay to unlock even more additional membership features (optional future feature).



Authentication Flow

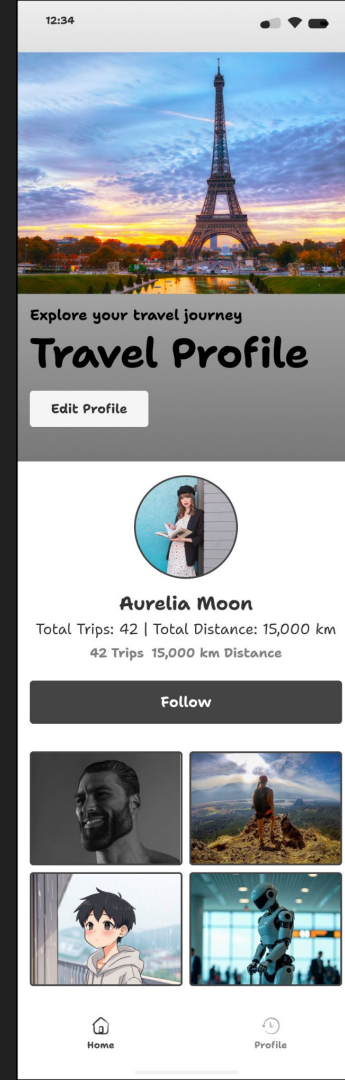


Authentication Flow (wireframes)



Social Profile

1. Profile: Users view their stats (trips logged, total distance) and a grid of their past recorded routes.
2. Following: Tapping the social icon opens a list of travelers the user follows; the "add" icon lets them follow others. This enables the multi-user interaction — one user's contributed routes become another's recommendations.



Trip Flow: Contribute



Tapping '**Start Trip**' requests location permission.



Granting '**While using the app**' starts background logging.



Google Maps launches for turn-by-turn navigation.



Roamly records path in background.



Google Maps handles active navigation.



Recording active notification is visible.



Tapping '**Stop Trip**' ends recording.

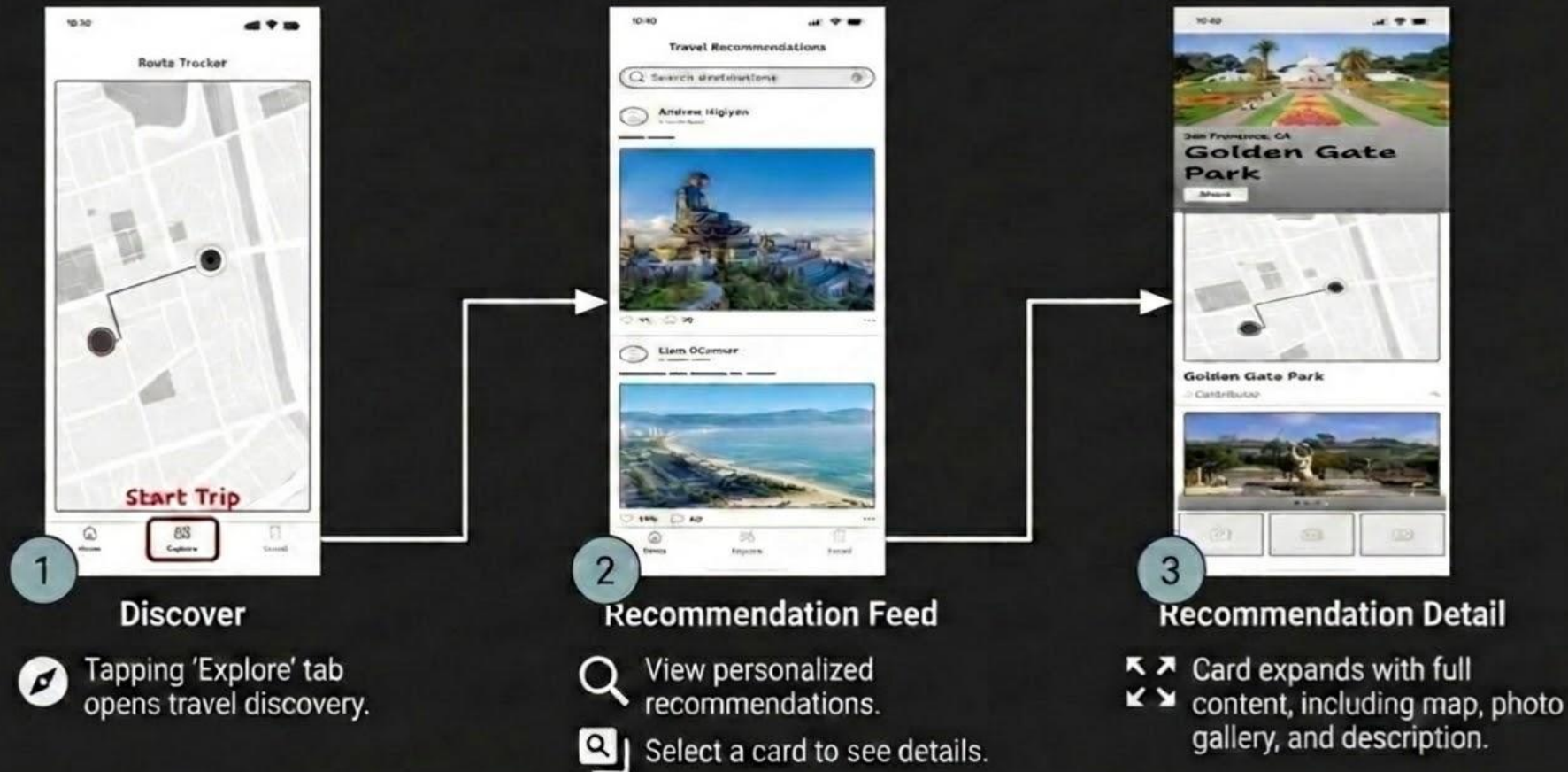


Saves route data to database.

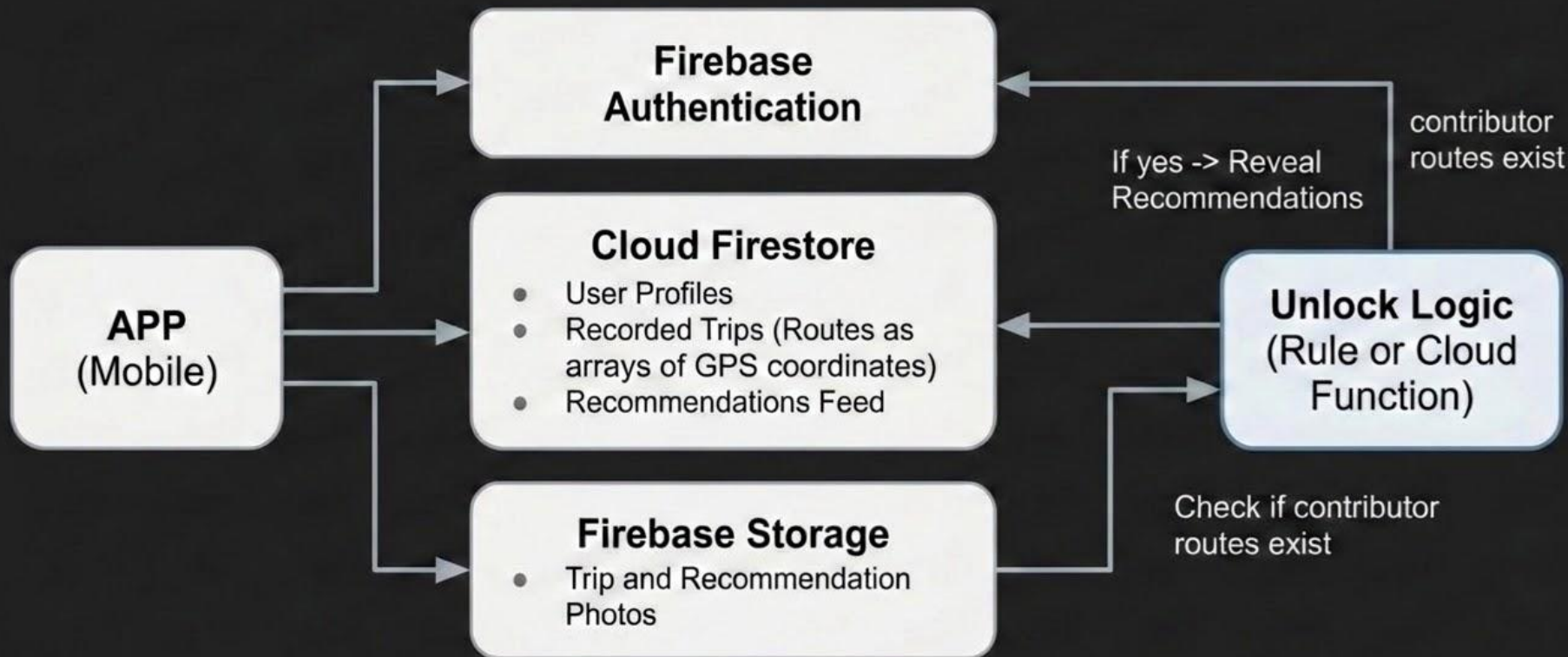


Unlocks new, non-commercial recommendations (give-to-get).

Discovery Flow: Unlock



Backend



Sensor



- **GPS / Fused Location Provider (primary)**

Roamly reads the device's location directly to log the route the user travels. This is the core data the app records and contributes — Google Maps handles navigation, but the route logging is Roamly's own.

- **Foreground Service**

keeps Roamly logging location in the background while Google Maps is open in the foreground.



(Optional / future): **Accelerometer** or **Activity Recognition** to detect movement vs. idle and improve accuracy.

Timeline

Jun 6–8: Firebase setup, Authentication, project scaffolding



Jun 12–14: Save trips to Firestore, Trip Summary with route polyline



Jun 18–19: Profile screen, social features, polish



Jun 9–11: Home screen + foreground service location logging + Google Maps launch



Jun 15–17: Recommendations feed + unlock-gate logic



Jun 20: Final testing + submission



Thank You!

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